

A diagnostic report for

The Scale Code Diagnostic

Swastik Coach

Ofbc Coach · Coaching / Courses / Info-products

Bangalore

The cross-force pattern that names what you are

THE AD-FUNDED FOUNDER

The founder who scaled the revenue by buying it — running paid ads to attract customers, but never doing the work of figuring out what makes them stay.

The classic version of this pattern is the small clinic owner spending ₹80,000/month on Google Ads with a landing page that says *"Quality healthcare for the family."* Zero results. They believe they have a marketing problem. They actually have a **position problem** wearing a marketing-spend costume.

You are running the **same pattern at 30 times the size**.

You've done what most founders running this pattern never manage: you scaled the ad spend, built a 22-person team to absorb the work, and crossed ₹25 Cr in revenue. On the outside it looks like a real company. But the underlying signals in your own answers are identical to the small clinic:

- **Q42 How marketing actually runs:** You picked *"Layer-3 Bleeder — ads with no clear message."*
- **Q39 Where the marketing money goes:** Ads, reels, agencies, hoardings.
- **Q43 Positioning chosen and defended:** None picked.
- **Q37 Two-word position:** Vague — "quality, trusted, premium, authentic."
- **Q44 Why customers come:** Not really word-of-mouth.
- **Q2 Why customers pick you:** "I haven't asked, but I'm pretty sure it's price, service, or quality."

You even told us where the real leverage is. On **Qx2** — the painful, high-value lever — you picked: **"Way 3 — more frequent transactions (repeat customers)."** Then on **Q67** — what you've actually worked on this year — you picked: **"Only Way 1 (more clients) — chasing leads."**

You know the answer. You're working on the comfortable lever (more leads) and avoiding the painful one (keeping the customers you already have). That's the pattern. Every new lead pushes back the harder conversation, which is *why are my existing customers leaving?*

THE MOVE THIS PATTERN ALWAYS REACHES FOR

"Better ads. Better creative. Better agency. Better funnel."

It's never the right answer. It's a marketing-spend fix to a position hole.

Why we placed you here

Q-ID	YOUR ANSWER	WHY IT MATTERS
Q42	Layer-3 Bleeder — ads with no clear position	This is the self-diagnosis. You ticked it.
Q17	More than 50% of revenue on marketing	The pattern is defined by paid spending. You're at 3-4x what a healthy coaching business spends.
Q9	"Don't track gross margin" + Q17 over 50%	Spending hard, can't tell what's coming back. Most reliable signal for this pattern.
Q43	None picked (positioning doorway)	Without a chosen position, you're paying premium ad rates for a message that hasn't been written.

Where you sit on the founder map

↑ **PULLED DEMAND** customers come to you — they know your category

The Personal Brand

Customers buy YOU — your name, voice, face.
Premium pricing, but founder-bound.

The Institution

Runs on the company name, not the founder.
Sellable, transferrable, durable.

The Grinder

Hustle keeps the lights on. If the founder stops dialling, revenue dies by Friday.

The Agency Model

Team delivers, founder still personally closes every big deal.

You sit here — but pulled back-left because customers still buy YOUR name (Q78) and "only I can" still includes one personal relationship (Q74).

← FOUNDER DEPENDENT

ASSET BUILT →

↓ **PUSHED DEMAND** you go to customers — paid ads, outbound

You don't sit cleanly in any quadrant. The 22-person headcount pushes you right (you've built an asset). But your customers still buy your personal name (Q78), conversion is under 10% (Q6), and there's at least one big relationship that requires your face (Q74) — all of which pulls you back left.

You're a **founder-dependent business running on a paid-ad engine**. That's the single most expensive position to occupy. You pay top dollar for the leads, then personally have to do the heavy lifting to close them.

Two other patterns you partly fit

The Agency Model — fits your size (22 people, well above the 8-person line) and your "founder-still-on-every-big-call" reality. You'd fully fit if your Optimisation and Financial scores were 3.5+. They're 1.5 and 1.6. The team is real; the operating discipline underneath the team is not.

The Grinder — fits your force profile exactly (X-Factor 0.9, Identity 1.8, Marketing 1.5 — all classic Grinder levels). Doesn't fit your structure (22 people, ₹25 Cr). You're running a Grinder's diagnostic inside an Agency Model's body — which is why you feel drained (Q14) at 40 hours/week. A pure Grinder works 70+ hours; you work 40 because you've hired around the work. But the *mental load* is the same.

The single belief your own data contradicts

THE X-FACTOR HUNT

The belief that your differentiator is somewhere in the building, you just haven't named it yet — when the truth is you've never asked the only people who would know.

WHY WE THINK YOU HOLD THIS

Q-ID	YOUR ANSWER
Q2 Why customers pick you	"I haven't asked, but I'm pretty sure it's price, service, or quality"
Q28 Cost you pay competitors won't	"None of these — yet"
Q31 How fast a competitor could copy you	"Overnight"
Q32 What customers feel because of your difference	"Haven't thought about it"

Q-ID	YOUR ANSWER
Q33 Can you write the referral sentence	"Honestly, I couldn't write one"
Q34 Chosen over a cheaper option	"I don't track this"
Q35 Self-rated X-Factor strength	1 out of 5 — no real X-Factor <i>(your own rating)</i>

Seven separate answers, one verdict. You haven't just *not built* a differentiator — you've never set up the conditions where one could become visible. You haven't asked. You haven't measured what customers feel. You haven't named one cost you pay that competitors refuse to. You haven't even written the sentence a happy customer would use.

WHAT IT'S COSTING YOU

On ₹25 Cr of revenue, marketing spend over 50% = at least **₹12.5 Cr/year** chasing leads into a funnel that converts less than 1 in 10 (Q6).

Now imagine that same funnel with a real, customer-tested reason to choose you — the kind that lifts conversion from under 10% to a healthy 20%. That's not "an improvement." That's **double the customers on the same ₹12.5 Cr of spend, without buying one extra impression.**

The X-Factor Hunt is a lie because while you're hunting for the answer inside your head, the people who would tell you for free — your existing customers — are sitting in your CRM, never asked. The cheapest answer in the business is the one you haven't gone to get.

There's a deeper cost too. The reason your conversion is under 10% and your "chasing leads" feels exhausting is that **you're pitching without knowing what to defend.** A sales call where you talk 70% of the time (Q49) on a generic offer ("price, service, quality") is your-voice filling the silence your customer's voice should have filled.

THE CONTRADICTION

WHAT YOU'D SAY	WHAT YOUR NUMBERS SAY
<i>"We're better. The customers who get it, get it."</i>	0 customers asked. 0 referral sentences written. 1 customer you can name by first name who would actually suffer if you closed. (Q2, Q33, Q29)
<i>"Marketing is working — we're at ₹25 Cr."</i>	More than 50% of revenue on marketing. Conversion under 10%. Repeat rate under 10%. No position chosen. (Q17, Q6, Q18, Q43)
<i>"My X-Factor is the quality of my work."</i>	You don't track gross margin. You have no written guarantee. You said your offering is copyable overnight. When you "refuse" things competitors do, the reason is "it's uncomfortable to admit." (Q9, Q47, Q31, Q30)

Pick any row. The right column is your data. The left column is the story you've been telling yourself.

Every score traces to your own answers

Your 8-Force depth at a glance (out of 5)



Every force is below 2.5/5. This isn't a fix-one-thing pattern — it's a foundation pattern. The worst by a clear gap is **X-Factor at 0.9**, and X-Factor is what every other force gets fixed through.

Force 1 — Identity · 1.8 / 5 · *Weak*

You describe your business by your job title — *"I'm a coach"* (Q19) — not by the change you create for the customer. When asked if a new competitor or new format has made you re-think what business you're in, you said **"yes, but I haven't done anything about it"** (Q26). Your current business definition is **"default — it's just what I started doing"** (Q27). The disappearance test holds 7-30 days (Q20) — that's the only thing pulling this score above 1.5.

Driven by: Q19, Q22 ("never lined them up"), Q27, Q26, Q21 ("can name something but it's still broad"). · **Coaching**

sector view: Coaching businesses live and die on who-you-serve clarity. Yours runs at the clarity level of a side business, scaled to enterprise size.

Force 2 — X-Factor · 0.9 / 5 · Critical

Already explained in §2. The lowest of the eight by a clear gap. **Q35 — your own self-rating: 1/5.** You and the diagnostic agree on this one.

Driven by: Q2, Q28, Q31, Q32, Q33, Q34, Q35. · **Coaching sector view:** Below the floor for any coaching practice that wants to last, at any size.

Force 3 — Marketing · 1.5 / 5 · Weak

This is where the most money is leaving. You spend more than 50% of revenue on marketing (Q17) — for a ₹25 Cr business, that's a marketing budget bigger than most coaching firms' entire revenue. It runs through ads, reels and agencies (Q39) with no position chosen (Q43), no two-word position (Q37 — "slogan mush"), and no tracking of which spend produced customers (Q41 — "I don't track this").

You called yourself a Layer-3 Bleeder (Q42) — meaning, spending on distribution channels without a clear message to put through them.

Driven by: Q17, Q42, Q43, Q37, Q39, Q44, Q40, Q41. · **Coaching sector view:** You're spending at the level of a venture-funded ₹100 Cr coaching brand, on a message that wouldn't get a ₹50L coach started.

Force 4 — Sales · 1.7 / 5 · Weak

Conversion is **less than 1 in 10** enquiries becoming customers (Q6). You talk roughly 70% of the time in first sales conversations (Q49). When you lose a deal, you default to "prospect wasn't serious" (Q51) and "economy or timing" (Q36) — both are external blame, neither is a useful diagnosis. You have no written guarantee (Q47). You haven't told a prospect "this isn't for you" in **over a year** (Q48).

What keeps this above 1.0: you can name the offer somewhat (Q46 — two of four levers) and your sales conversations end in a mix of stalls and advances rather than pure dead ends (Q52).

Driven by: Q6, Q49, Q51, Q36, Q47, Q48. · **Coaching sector view:** A sub-10% conversion at the volume your marketing buys is the single biggest source of money being thrown away in your business.

Force 5 — Financial · 1.6 / 5 · Weak

This is the section that should keep you up at night. Owner salary: ₹0 (Q55). Replacement wage you said the market would demand: ₹2,00,000/month (Q56). Real margin once that's added back: 5-10% (Q57). Gross margin: untracked (Q9). Profit allocation: zero (Q59). Drawings: "whenever there's cash" (Q60). Marketing burn: untracked (Q41). Pricing: based on competitors (Q61), not on value.

Two redeeming signals: you sat with last year's P&L this quarter (Q62), and you keep 2 separate bank accounts (Q58). Those prevent the score from dropping to 0.8.

Driven by: Q55, Q56, Q57, Q59, Q60, Q61, Q9. · **Coaching sector view:** A ₹25 Cr top line running on the financial discipline of a ₹50L business. The first cash crunch will find every one of these gaps.

Force 6 — Optimisation · 1.5 / 5 · Weak

You can't name one specific bottleneck (Q64 — you picked "team / cash / leads," a category, not a bottleneck). 0% of last quarter's growth spend went to your named bottleneck (Q65 — "don't know"). You track no

single weekly throughput number (Q71 — "gut feel"). Your value chain is in your head, not written (Q69). You've done neither "exploit before you elevate" (Q66) — meaning, get free gains from existing capacity before you hire more.

The one good signal: you correctly identified Way 3 (repeat customers / higher frequency) as the painful, high-value lever (Qx2). You know where the leverage is. You're just not working it.

Driven by: Q64, Q65, Q67 (only Way 1), Q69, Q70, Q71. · **Coaching sector view:** The 22-person team works without a constraint-aware operating system. Adding a 23rd person now would compound the disorganisation, not fix it.

Force 7 — Scale · 2.3 / 5 · Soft — the strongest

This is where you've actually built something. **You have one named, productized offering** (Q79). Your last hire was admin (Q75 — exactly the right first rung). Your vacation test holds at 7-14 days (Q73). If demand tripled tomorrow, your team would break first (Q13 — you said this directly).

What it's NOT: top customers buy your personal name, not the firm name (Q78). The "only I can" list includes one relationship that needs your face (Q74). If a buyer offered fair cash today, the business survives "partially" without you in 90 days (Q80). The productized offering doesn't pass any of the three real-product tests — teachable, valuable, repeatable (Q77 — "none: it's bespoke").

Driven by: Q79 (+), Q75 (+), Q73, Q13, Q78 (–), Q74 (–), Q77 (–). · **Coaching sector view:** You've started building the asset. You've stopped halfway. What exists is fragile.

Force 8 — Owner Energy · 1.9 / 5 · Weak

Drained, firefighting most days (Q14). Zero hours of distraction-free deep work per week (Q82). "Everything feels important" — no priority list named (Q83). Phone in your hand within 5 minutes of waking (Q85). Thinking time is occasional, not on calendar (Q88). "Don't know what to subtract" (Q89).

But — and this matters — **you sleep 7+ hours on 15-20 nights out of the last 28** (Q86). You actively subtracted something significant this quarter (Q84). You hired admin first (Q75). You said no to 1-3 of the last 10 small asks (Q87). Five positive signals balance the drain.

The picture: a reactive operating mode (phone-first, WhatsApp-heavy, no priority) **wrapped around a body that is still recovering well**. You haven't damaged the engine yet. You're running it on the wrong settings.

Driven by: Q14, Q82, Q83, Q85, Q88, Q89 (–) vs Q86, Q84, Q87 (+). · **Coaching sector view:** You have 6-12 months of runway on your current pattern before sleep or focus starts to give. The window to redesign the day before your body forces it is now.

One sprint. One number. One sentence.

THE CUSTOMER-VOICE SPRINT

In the next 90 days, get one sentence — in your customers' exact words — explaining why they bought you over the cheaper alternative they were also considering.

Target: 30 customer interviews completed → 5 verbatim sentences written down → 1 chosen as the position you will defend for the next 12 months.

WHY THIS MOVE, NOT ANOTHER

Your weakest force is X-Factor (0.9), and that weakness sits underneath every other force's weakness. You can't fix marketing until you know what to say. You can't fix sales conversion until you know what to defend. You can't fix financial discipline until you can charge a real price for a real position. **A position written without customer evidence is a position that won't survive the first time a prospect pushes back on price.**

You need raw material. Your existing customers are the only people who have it.

The 4-Week Plan

WEEK	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU STOP DOING
1 — Set up	Pull the list of every customer who bought in the last 18 months. Score by recency + engagement. Pick 30. Send the call request personally — no team, no template, your name in the subject line.	Don't review ad creative this week. Don't start new agency conversations.
2 — Listen	30 calls, 30 minutes each. Three questions only: (a) What were you doing before you bought from us? (b) What other options were you considering? (c) Why did you pick us? Record everything.	Don't attend any internal meeting that isn't about delivery.

WEEK	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU STOP DOING
3 — Pattern-spot	Pull the verbatim sentences. Cluster them. Find the 3-5 phrases customers actually say (not what you wish they said).	No "creative reviews" with the agency. They have nothing to optimise until Week 4.
4 — Lock	Pick ONE sentence. Re-brief the agency, sales team, landing pages. Set a 12-week defence period — no changes to position. Track whether conversion moves.	Stop <i>all</i> positioning experiments outside the chosen sentence.

The Stop-Doing List (specific to your answers)

These are five things to actively *stop* — not "deprioritise," not "later" — for the full 90 days:

- 1 Stop spending the next ₹50L of marketing budget on new ads.** Redirect it to: (a) the 30 calls (cost: near-zero), (b) the cost of redoing landing pages once you have the sentence (₹2-3L), (c) reserve. Anything left over becomes the *defence fund* for the new position. [Q17]
- 2 Stop attending sales calls where you talk more than 50% of the time.** Set a timer. If you cross 50%, end the call. [Q49]
- 3 Stop saying "the economy" or "the timing" out loud about lost deals.** Replace with one of: "they wanted a guarantee I don't offer," "I didn't ask them what they were comparing me to," "I talked instead of listening." [Q36, Q51]
- 4 Stop hiring anyone new — including the next agency, coach-trainer, ops person — for the full 90 days.** With 22 people and no named bottleneck (Q64), the next hire makes the disorganisation worse, not better. [Q12, Q64]
- 5 Stop checking WhatsApp / email / Instagram in the first 60 minutes of waking.** First action of the day is one 30-minute block on the Customer-Voice Sprint. Phone after that. [Q85, Q88]

YOUR FIRST CONCRETE ACTION

Open your CRM. Pick the three customers who bought most recently AND are still active.

Send each one a calendar link for a 30-minute "I'd love your honest take" call. Use your own name, your own phone — not your assistant, not a Calendly email blast.

You can do this in the next 20 minutes. If you have not booked three calls by Friday night of the week you read this report, the rest of the sprint will not happen.

How you compare to other coaching businesses your size

Comparison group: Indian SME coaching, courses and info-product businesses at the ₹3-25 Cr revenue band. Sample is directional, not a formal industry dataset (n ≈ 25 founders).

METRIC	YOU	MEDIAN FOR COACHING	TOP QUARTILE
Marketing as % of revenue	>50%	18%	8%
Conversion of qualified enquiries	<10%	22%	35%+
Repeat / continuation rate	<10%	35%	60%+
Customers asked verbatim "why did you buy"	0	6-10	20+
Owner monthly salary	₹0	₹1.5L	₹3L+
Revenue per team member	₹1.14 Cr	₹0.85 Cr	₹1.5 Cr
Real margin (after replacing your own wage)	5-10%	18%	30%+

WHERE YOU STAND OUT — IN TWO DIRECTIONS AT ONCE

You are **above the top quartile** on revenue-per-team-member (good — your team's *output volume* is real). You are **massively below median** on every quality-of-revenue metric (marketing efficiency, conversion, retention, pricing power, what you pay yourself).

The disconnect is the diagnosis: you've optimised the team's *output* without optimising the *quality* of what that output is buying.

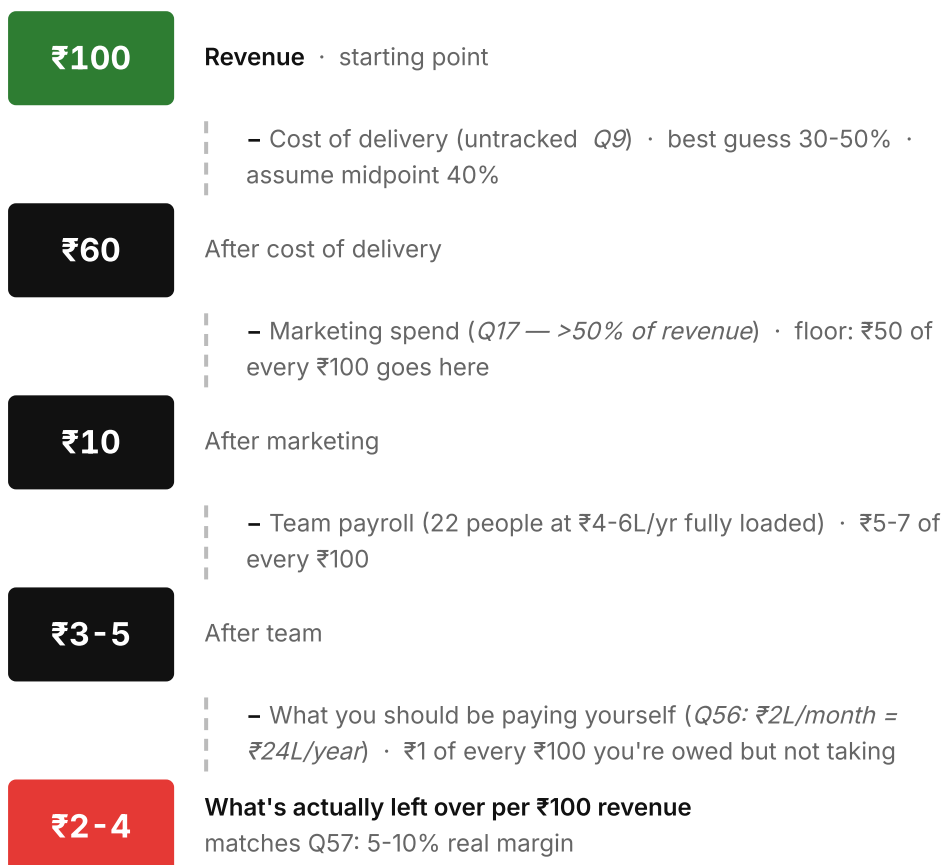
A healthy coaching firm at your revenue would spend roughly ₹4.5 Cr/year on marketing (not ₹12.5 Cr+), convert at roughly 22% (not <10%), and the founder would draw around ₹36L/year (not ₹0).

The same revenue, restructured to healthy economics, would produce roughly ₹6-8 Cr of additional annual cash — without one extra customer.

Source: 100+ Indian SME audits and Swastik's coaching work, directional. Honest gap: coaching has more variance than service businesses, so treat top-quartile numbers as targets to defend, not floors.

Your own numbers, traced

₹100 of your revenue, traced down to what's actually left



The picture in one line: out of every ₹100 of revenue, **about ₹2-4 is left after honest costs.** The reason your books look healthier than this is that you're not paying yourself.

YOUR MINIMUM CASH CUSHION

With 1-3 months of cash runway (Q10) on a ₹25 Cr business, your minimum operational cash sits between ₹2 Cr and ₹6 Cr. If marketing spend doesn't generate revenue for a single 30-day cycle, you breach that floor.

Four-line verdict

1. **You can't see your gross margin** (Q9). For a ₹25 Cr business, this is the single biggest financial blind spot — every other number below needs this one.
2. **Your marketing burn is structurally too high** for the conversion rate it produces. Until conversion moves above 20%, cutting this is the highest-leverage move in the business.
3. **Your owner salary is a hidden subsidy of ₹24L/year** flowing from you, personally, into the firm. The P&L looks healthier than it is because this line is invisible.
4. **A 1-3 month cash runway on a ₹25 Cr ad-funded operation is not a buffer.** It's a one-bad-month-away-from-emergency posture.

The dependency you didn't think about

Your business is roughly

50%

dependent on one thing: **ongoing ad spend.**

Not on you personally — you have 22 people, that's diluted some of the founder dependency. Not on one channel partner. Not on one big customer (Q3: top-3 concentration is only 5%, healthily spread).

The dependency is on **the marketing budget continuing to be funded at over 50% of revenue, every single month.**

This is a more dangerous concentration than customer concentration. A founder with 50% revenue from one big customer at least knows that customer's name and can defend the relationship. **You cannot defend an ad budget — you can only keep funding it.**

TWO QUESTIONS YOU SHOULD ANSWER IN 30 SECONDS, BUT PROBABLY CAN'T

1. If your monthly marketing budget got halved tomorrow, what's your revenue 90 days later?

(You don't know. Q41 — marketing burn untracked. Q65 — bottleneck spend untracked.)

2. Which 20% of last quarter's marketing spend produced 80% of the qualified leads?

(You don't know. Q41. Q71 — no throughput number.)

Until you can answer both, you are buying time, not building leverage.

What this report helps you decide

Decision 1 — Do I hire next, and for which role?

Recommendation: don't hire anyone in the next 90 days.

Your bottleneck (Q64) is not yet named. Your 22-person team is operating without a clear operating system underneath it (Q70). Hiring person #23 right now would compound the disorganisation, not fix it.

If you're pressed on *which* role would be the right one when you're ready — it's a **Head of Marketing whose first 90 days are the Customer-Voice Sprint plus rebuilding the position.** Not a marketing executor. Someone who can architect the position itself.

Decision 2 — Raise prices, hold, or restructure the offers?

Recommendation: restructure the offers first, then raise prices on the new structure.

Raising prices on your current offering (Q77 — bespoke, fails all three real-product tests) doesn't survive sales conversations, because there's no defensible reason for the price.

Restructure first: take your one named offering (Q79 — the asset you've actually built) and make it teachable, valuable, repeatable. Then re-price it on the basis of the verbatim customer sentences you've gathered in the Sprint.

Decision 3 — Where do I cut vs double down this quarter?

Recommendation: cut new ad spend, cut new hires, cut new positioning experiments.

Double down on three things only.

- The 30 customer calls.
- Restructuring the one named offering.
- Paying yourself ₹2L/month for three months as the discipline anchor that forces every other decision to align.

The first month you can't make payroll *and* pay yourself ₹2L will be the first month you're allowed to change something structural about the business. That single constraint will teach you more about your operating reality than any analytics dashboard.

The dated commitment

REOPEN THIS PAGE ON
23 August 2026
— these five numbers should have moved —

NUMBER	TODAY (25 MAY 2026)	TARGET (23 AUG 2026)
Customer interviews completed (verbatim sentences captured)	0	30
Conversion of qualified enquiries	<10%	15%+ (path to 20%)
Marketing spend as % of revenue	>50%	<40% (reallocation)
Owner monthly salary actually paid	₹0	₹2,00,000
Named, documented bottleneck (one specific name)	None — "team / cash / leads"	One specific process, asset, or policy

Signature: Date:

If three of the five have moved, this report earned its place. If five of five have moved, the next conversation you and I have looks very different from this one.

Your full answer record (highlights)

Q-ID	QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER	SCORE
Q1	Who is your ideal customer?	Type only	2/5
Q2	Why do customers pick you?	Haven't asked — assume price/service/quality	1/5
Q3	% revenue from top 3 customers	5%	(good)
Q6	Conversion of enquiries	Less than 1 in 10	1/5
Q8	Revenue (₹ lakhs)	2,500 (= ₹25 Cr)	—
Q9	Gross margin	Don't track	0/5
Q12	Headcount	22	—
Q14	Owner energy	Drained, firefighting	1/5
Q17	Marketing as % of revenue	Over 50%	2/5
Q19	How you describe the business	Job title ("I'm a coach")	1/5
Q26	Has a competitor made you re-think?	Yes, but no action	2/5
Q28	Cost you pay competitors won't	None — yet	0/5
Q31	How fast a competitor could copy you	Overnight	0/5
Q42	Marketing pattern	Layer-3 Bleeder	2/5
Q43	Positioning doorway chosen	None picked	0/5
Q55	Owner monthly salary	₹0	(red flag)

Q-ID	QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER	SCORE
Q56	Replacement wage	₹2,00,000/month	—
Q57	Real pretax margin	5-10%	2/5
Q59	Profit allocation sweep	Zero	0/5
Q67	Growth levers worked	Only Way 1 (more clients)	1/5
Q73	Vacation test	7-14 days	2/5
Q79	Named, productized offering	Yes, one	4/5
Q82	Deep-work hours per week	Zero	1/5
Q83	Vital Few named	"Everything feels important"	1/5
Q85	Phone within X mins of waking	Under 5 minutes	1/5
Q86	Sleep 7+ hours (last 4 weeks)	15-20 nights	4/5
Q89	What's stopping freedom	"Don't know what to subtract"	2/5

Full 96-answer trace available on request.

Glossary

THE 8 FORCES

The eight depth dimensions of the bootcamp curriculum.

- **Identity (1):** who you serve and what business you're actually in.
- **X-Factor (2):** the cost you pay that competitors refuse to.
- **Marketing (3):** the position, the message, the channel.
- **Sales (4):** turning interest into a paying customer.
- **Financial (5):** the honesty of your numbers.
- **Optimisation (6):** working through the real bottleneck, not around it.
- **Scale (7):** the asset that exists without you.
- **Owner Energy (8):** what you've subtracted to make the important few possible.

THE 9 LIES

Common founder beliefs the bootcamp surfaces and breaks. Identity Trap, X-Factor Hunt, Marketing Lie, Sales Lie, Conversion Lie, Profit Lie, Growth Lie, Freedom Lie, Death Spiral.

THE 7 FOUNDER ARCHETYPES

Cross-force patterns common to Indian SME founders. The Grinder, The Inheritor, The Migrator (*here called The Ad-Funded Founder for plain language*), The Name (*The Personal Brand*), The Rainmaker's Firm (*The Agency Model*), The Institution, The Architect.

REPLACEMENT WAGE (BUS TEST)

What the market would pay to do your job, end-to-end. Used to correct the real margin — true profit = stated profit minus the implicit subsidy of paying yourself less than market.

LAYER-3 BLEEDER

Running paid distribution (ads, reels, agencies) without a clear position underneath. The single most expensive recoverable mistake in Indian SME marketing.

CUSTOMER-VOICE SPRINT

A 90-day instrument — 30 customer interviews → 5 verbatim sentences → 1 chosen position. The rule: a position written without customer evidence won't survive its first pricing objection.

Methodology

Three-step pipeline. (1) A scoring engine computes your 8 force depths from your 96 answers via a published rubric. (2) Stage band + force fingerprint + specific question tiebreakers pick your archetype. (3) The Lie is picked from your weakest force and specific answer patterns. The prose in this report was written by Claude (Anthropic) from the structured payload, not template-substituted. Report engine version: 1-prose.

Report ends. Reread date: 23 August 2026.